

EFFORT GUIDE · RPE /10

RECOVERY

RPE 1–2

Soft pedal · chatty

ENDURANCE

RPE 3–4

All-day · full sentences

TEMPO

RPE 5–6

Comfortably hard

SWEET SPOT

RPE 7

Hard but holdable

THRESHOLD

RPE 8

Very hard · one word

VO2 / EFFORTS

RPE 9–10

Can't talk

Day 1

TUESDAY · THRESHOLD

WARM-UP

- W1

Easy spin, build gradually

15 min

RPE 2

90–95 rpm

Heart rate drifts up on its own, don't force it. Smooth, relaxed.
- W2

Fast-cadence bursts

3 × 1 min

100+ rpm

Spin-ups to open the legs. 1 min easy between each.

MAIN SET · THRESHOLD

- M1

Threshold intervals

3–4 sets

8–12 min

RPE 8

90–100 rpm

RPE 8: very hard but steady, one-word answers only. HR climbs and plateaus high; hold it level, don't accelerate (your test weak spot). 4 min easy spin between. Progression: Wk 1–2 = 3 × 8 min · Wk 3–5 = 3 × 10 min · Wk 6–8 = 3 × 12 min · Wk 9–10 = 4 × 10 min.
- C1

Cool-down spin

10 min

RPE 1–2

Soft pedal until HR settles, flush the legs.

Day 2

THURSDAY · SWEET SPOT

ATHLEEK CYCLING

DAY 2 · SWEET SPOT · ~65 MIN

W1 Easy spin warm-up

10 min

RPE 2–3

Build to the edge of "comfortably hard" before the first rep.

MAIN SET · SWEET SPOT

M1 Sweet-spot intervals

2–3 sets

12–20 min

RPE 7

RPE 7: hard but holdable, a few words at a time. This is the biggest fitness driver for 100-mile riding. 5 min easy between reps. Progression: Wk 1–3 = 3 × 12 min · Wk 4–6 = 3 × 15 min · Wk 7–8 = 2 × 20 min · Wk 9–10 = 3 × 20 min.

M2 Over-unders (add from Wk 6)

3 × 8 min

RPE 7↔8

Alternate 1 min @ RPE 7 / 1 min @ RPE 8 inside each rep. Teaches you to ride through a hard effort and recover while still pedalling, exactly what rolling terrain demands. 4 min easy between sets.

C1 Cool-down spin

10 min

RPE 1–2

MAIN RIDE · ENDURANCE

- M1

Steady endurance ride

progressive

RPE 3–4

85–95 rpm

RPE 3–4: you should be able to hold a full conversation the whole way. If you can't talk in sentences, you're going too hard. Watch HR drift late in long rides; ease off rather than let it climb. Time in the saddle wins the 100 miles, not speed.
- M2

Tempo efforts (from Wk 5)

4–6 × 5 min

RPE 5–6

RPE 5–6 on the climbs to mimic the rolling parts of the route. Eat just before each effort so you rehearse fuelling under load.

LONG RIDE: HOW FAR EACH WEEK

PHASE 1 · BUILD THE BASE

- Wk 1

Long ride

2 hr 00

~30 mi
- Wk 2

Long ride

2 hr 30

~37 mi
- Wk 3

Long ride

3 hr 00

~45 mi
- Wk 4

Easier week

Shorter ride so the body absorbs the work.

2 hr 00

~30 mi

PHASE 2 · GET LONGER, ADD HILLS

- Wk 5

Long ride + hill efforts

Start adding RPE 5–6 efforts on the climbs.

3 hr 30

~52 mi
- Wk 6

Long ride + hill efforts

4 hr 00

~60 mi
- Wk 7

Long ride + hill efforts

4 hr 30

~67 mi
- Wk 8

Easier week

3 hr 00

~45 mi

PHASE 3 · PEAK, THEN TAPER

- Wk 9

Dress-rehearsal ride

Full event kit, fuel and bottles exactly as planned for the day.

5 hr 00

~75 mi
- Wk 10

Longest ride

Your biggest day. On event day, adrenaline and the group carry the final stretch.

5 hr 30

~82 mi
- Wk 11

Taper, ease right back

Less time on the bike to arrive fresh. Resist doing more.

3 hr 00

~45 mi
- Wk 12

 Event day

Hold RPE 4–5, eat early and often, don't chase wheels up the early climbs.

100 mi

FUEL & HYDRATION · PRACTISE EVERY LONG RIDE

F1

Carbs on the bike

60–90g/hr

60–90g/hr once rides pass 90 min. Train the stomach too. Never trial new food on ride day.

F2

Drink on a schedule

~1 bottle/hr

Sip every 15–20 min. ~1 bottle/hr, add electrolytes if hot.